

Pink Quote is an electronic quotation system operated by Pink OTC Markets. In addition to OTCBB stocks, it covers inactive stocks, gray market stocks that rarely trade, penny stocks, and those with a narrow geographic interest. Many Pink Quote-only companies are not able or willing to provide financial information and required SEC disclosure documents. Years ago, securities dealers who were members of the National Quotation Bureau (NQB) would publish weekly bid and ask prices for these stocks on long sheets of pink paper, thus the name Pink Sheets. The list would be distributed to all brokerage firms.

[Table 6-2](#) is a breakdown of where stocks trade in the United States. The table includes only individual U.S. common equities. It does not include listed bonds, preferred stocks, exchange-traded mutual funds, or foreign stocks listed on U.S. exchanges.

TABLE 6-2

Approximate Number of U.S. Companies on Each Exchange

Stocks Sorted by Exchange	Number of Companies	Percent of Total Market Value
NYSE (U.S. equities)	1,600+	80%
Nasdaq (U.S. equities)	3,400+	19%
Bulletin-board stocks	22,000+	<1%

Source: NYSE EuroNext, Nasdaq

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THE BROAD STOCK MARKET

Wilshire Associates is a privately owned investment firm with headquarters in Santa Monica, California. Since its founding in 1972, the company has developed a wide variety of U.S. indexes, one of which is the Wilshire 5000 Composite Index. The Wilshire 5000, as it is commonly known, was the first U.S. equity index to capture the return of the entire market of U.S. stocks that trade on the NYSE and Nasdaq (the American Stock Exchange merged with the NYSE in 2008). Bulletin board stocks are not included in Wilshire indexes.